

Sebastian Lukas Ahlstick

Address

Copenhagen Business School
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Education

Copenhagen Business School (CBS): Ph.D. International Economics, Government and Business, 01/2023 – 12/2026

PhD Dissertation Title: Beneficial but Imperfectly Used: On the Utilization of PTAs

Supervision: Prof. Ari Kokko, Dr. Jan Stuckatz, Dr. Patrik Tingvall

Stockholm School of Economics: Visiting Ph.D. Student, 09/2024 – 01/2025

Humboldt University Berlin: MSc Economics, 10/2021, First Class Honours

Copenhagen Business School: Visiting MA Student, Economics, 08/2020 – 01/2021

Munich University of Applied Sciences: BA Business Administration, 03/2019, First Class Honours

Sapienza - Università di Roma: Visiting BA Student, Economics, 09/2018 – 01/2019

Research Interests

International Trade, International Political Economy, Preferential Trade Agreements

Quantitative Methods, Big Data

Communication

1. **Ahlstick, Sebastian.** (2025). "Unlocking the Potential of Preferential Trade Agreements." [The Search for Impact through Entrepreneurship \(podcast\), Copenhagen School of Entrepreneurship, Episode 7, 2025.](#)
2. **Ahlstick, Sebastian,** and Kokko, Ari. (2025). Sådan bliver EU en troværdig og stabil modvægt til et uforudsigeligt USA, [Altinget Erherv, 8 Sep 2025.](#)
3. **Ahlstick, Sebastian,** and Karlsson, Lars. (2024). Explaining utilization of preferential tariffs: new perspectives, [WCO News, Volume 104, Issue 2.](#)

Work in Progress

1. **Ahlstick, Sebastian,** and Stuckatz, Jan. (2026). "Preferential" Trade Agreements? Working Paper.
2. Bertram, Caroline, and **Ahlstick, Sebastian** (2026). Europe's Green Trade Squeeze. Working Paper.
3. **Ahlstick, Sebastian,** and Kokko, Ari. (2026). When Preferences End: GSP Graduation and the Reconfiguration of Regional Value Chains. Working Paper.
4. **Ahlstick, Sebastian.** (2025). Country-level Explanations For the Underutilization of Preferential Trade Agreements. Working Paper.

Research Grants

Unlocking The Potential of Preferential Trade Agreements. Innoexplorer, *Innovationsfonden Denmark*: PI, conducted at Copenhagen Business School, Department of International Economics, Government, and Business, 2025-2026. **Total: DKK 1,496,231 (\$220,000).**

Invited Talks

2026 Canadian Society of Customs Brokers National Conference, Ottawa, Canada, 09/2026 (confirmed speaker)

2026 Canada Conference, International Compliance Professionals Association, Toronto, Canada, 06/2026

Appetiser for ASCEND - A Taste of the Innovation Ecosystem in Denmark, Copenhagen, Denmark, 11/2025

AP Møller Maersk - Customs Client Forum, Copenhagen, Denmark, 05/2025 & 04/2024

EFTA - Bringing the Analysis on FTA Utilisation to the Next Level, Geneva, Switzerland, 04/2025

Sino-Danish Research Center - Investment, Trade and Geo-economic Challenges, Beijing, China, 12/2024 & 12/2023

Volvo Car AB, Gothenburg, Sweden, 15 October 2024

Conference Presentations

International Conference on Economics of Global Interactions: 2026

CefES International Conferences, International Conference on European Economics and Politics: 2026

Centre for Inclusive Trade Policy (CITP), Academic Conference: 2026

Political Economy of International Organization (PEIO), Annual Conference: 2026

Nordic International Trade Seminar: 2024

European Trade Study Group: 2024

Teaching Experience

Research Design and Quantitative Methods I, Copenhagen Business School, BSc in Business Administration and Sociology, Spring 2023 & Spring 2024

Business and European Governance, Copenhagen Business School, BSc in Europæisk Business, co-taught with Ayca Uygur Wessel, Fall 2023

Professional Experience

Kommerskollegium - National Board of Trade Sweden, Affiliated Researcher, Stockholm, 09/2024 — 03/2025

Deutsche Börse Group, Risk Management, Financial Talent Programme, Luxembourg, 09/2022 — 12/2022.

European External Action Service, Trade & Economics Section, EU Delegation to Switzerland and Liechtenstein, Bern, 03/2022 – 08/2022.

UniCredit Bank AG, Short- & Mid-term Treasury, Americas Region, New York City, 04/2019 – 07/2019.

UniCredit Bank AG, Dual Course of Studies, Specialisation: Short-Term Liquidity Management & Treasury, Munich, 2015 – 2019.

UniCredit Bank AG, Markets Summer Internship, London, 08/2017.

Munich University of Applied Sciences, Research Assistant, Pricing of Options, Swaps and Swaptions, Munich, 11/2018 – 03/2019.

Professional Training

Barcelona School of Economics - Summer School, Quantitative Methods for Public Policy Analysis, 07/2024.

Barcelona School of Economics - Summer School, Panel Data Analysis, 06/2024 — 07/2024.

I.S.E.O Summer School, Istituto di Studi Economici e per L'Occupazione, 06/2023.

Scholarships & Awards

Adam Smith Fellowship, Mercatus Center at George Mason University, 2023 — 2024 (**\$5,000**)

Fee Waiver, "I.S.E.O Summer School", Istituto di Studi Economici e per L'Occupazione, 2023

Skills

Languages: German (native), English (fluent), Italian (fluent), French (fluent), Danish (intermediate)

Software: R, Stata, MatLab, $\LaTeX$, MySQL, PostgreSQL, SQLite